

# **BAIS: International Relations**

**Nation, Race, and Gender**

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## In-Class Survey

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Take the survey before we begin.



[https://fra1.qualtrics.com/jfe/form/SV\\_8ADA8mJ549QFFzw](https://fra1.qualtrics.com/jfe/form/SV_8ADA8mJ549QFFzw)

# Roadmap

## Where we are going today

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1. What is a nation? (Heywood & Whitham, ch. 8)
2. Where does nationalism come from? Primordialist and modernist accounts
3. Nationalism in IR theory: realist, liberal, constructivist, Marxist
4. Two cases on ethnic vs. civic nationalism in crisis: Korea and Ukraine
5. **Break + survey results**
6. Race, identity, and the politics of difference (ch. 9)
7. Gender and nationalism (Nagel)
8. Nationalism today

Definitions of nationalism are in the appendix; full references are in the supplementary reading guide on Brightspace.

# What is a Nation?

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## Three Dimensions of the Nation

Heywood & Whitham, *Global Politics* (3rd ed.), ch. 8

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A nation is a complex phenomenon shaped by cultural, political, and psychological factors.

- **Cultural** – a group bound by common language, religion, history, traditions. *All nations are culturally heterogeneous to some degree.*
- **Political** – a group that regards itself as a natural political community, usually expressed through the desire for sovereignty.
- **Psychological** – a group distinguished by shared loyalty or affection (patriotism). One can recognize membership without national pride.

Source: Heywood & Whitham (2023), pp. 229–230.

# Nation, State, Country, Ethnic Group

## Words that get conflated

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| Term         | What it is                                                                                                                         |
|--------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Nation       | A self-identifying community with cultural, political, and psychological dimensions. May or may not be defined by an ethnic group. |
| State        | A sovereign political-legal entity with a monopoly on legitimate force inside a defined territory.                                 |
| Country      | The territory itself; loosely interchangeable with state in everyday speech.                                                       |
| Nation-state | A political form in which the nation and the state are claimed to coincide. The modal aspiration of nationalism.                   |
| Ethnic group | A community defined by descent, language, or culture; may or may not see itself as a nation.                                       |

# Imagined Communities

Anderson (1983)

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*"An imagined political community – imagined as both inherently limited and sovereign."* –  
Anderson (1983), p. 6.

- **Imagined** – members will never meet most fellow members; the image of communion lives in their minds.
- **Limited** – every nation has finite, if elastic, boundaries; beyond them lie other nations.
- **Sovereign** – the nation is the legitimate site of political authority, replacing the divine right of kings.
- **Community** – regardless of internal inequality, conceived as a horizontal comradeship.

# Objective and Subjective Markers

No nation is held together by either alone

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- **Objective markers** include language, religion, shared history, territory. Useful but never sufficient: Switzerland thrives on three languages; Germany unifies across Catholic–Protestant lines.
- **Subjective markers** include shared loyalty, the sense of common destiny, and willingness to make sacrifices for fellow members.
- Nations are typically anchored by a *combination* of both, in proportions that vary by case and that shift over time.

## Working definition for today

A nation is a self-identifying community that combines cultural markers, political claims to sovereignty, and a psychological attachment among members – imagined, but consequential.



# Where Does Nationalism Come From?

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# The Big Question

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Is the nation an ancient inheritance, or a modern invention?

- For **primordialists**, nations are extensions of ethnic and cultural communities that go back centuries or millennia. Nationalism awakens what was already there.
- For **modernists**, the nation is a product of the late eighteenth century: a political response to industrialization, mass literacy, and the collapse of dynastic legitimacy. Nationalism creates nations, not the other way around.

This is the central debate in the study of nationalism, and it has policy stakes – it shapes how we read everything from Hindutva to the war in Ukraine.

## Primordialist vs. Modernist

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|                                    | <b>Primordialist</b>                             | <b>Modernist</b>                                                        |
|------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Origin of the nation               | Ancient ethnic, religious, or cultural community | Late-18th / 19th-century political construction                         |
| Core mechanism                     | Inherited bonds of kinship, language, faith      | Industrial economy + vernacular print + mass schooling                  |
| Key thinkers                       | Herder, Smith, Connor                            | Gellner, Hobsbawm, Anderson                                             |
| How nationalism relates to nations | Nations come first; nationalism awakens them     | Nationalism comes first; nations are its product                        |
| Empirical fit                      | Strong for cases with deep ethno-religious roots | Strong for the timing puzzle: why does nationalism appear when it does? |

See appendix for verbatim definitions from Anderson, Gellner, Connor, Greenfeld, Hechter, and Smith.

# Gellner's Modernist Account

## Industrial society demands cultural homogeneity

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- Pre-industrial societies were vertical and segmented: peasants, clergy, nobility – each with its own culture and dialect, no need for a shared one.
- Industrial economies require a mobile workforce literate in a single high culture. The state becomes the producer and protector of that culture, through mass schooling.
- The nation is the cultural unit that emerges to fit the political and economic requirements of industrial modernity. Nationalism is the doctrine that “the political and the national unit should be congruent” (Gellner, 1983, p. 1).

### Implication

Without industrial modernity, nationalism as we know it does not appear. This is why nationalism has roots in late 18th-century Europe and spreads outward from there.

# Anderson's Print Capitalism

## Vernaculars, novels, newspapers, simultaneity

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- Once Latin lost ground to vernacular printing, capitalist publishers needed mass audiences. Print created stable national languages out of dialect clouds.
- The novel and the newspaper taught readers to imagine many strangers as part of the same community moving through the same time – “simultaneity.”
- The nation became thinkable as a horizontal community of readers *simultaneously* consuming the same news, novels, and almanacs.

*“The convergence of capitalism and print technology on the fatal diversity of human language created the possibility of a new form of imagined community.”* – Anderson (1983), p. 46.

# Nationalism in IR Theory

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# Why IR Has Trouble with Nationalism

Griffiths and Sullivan (1997)

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- Mainstream IR takes *states* as the unit of analysis – but the nation is not the same thing as the state.
- Realist, liberal, and Marxist theories often treat national identity as fixed background, not as something to be explained.
- Constructivism reopens the question: where do state interests come from? Why do members of a nation accept costly sacrifices for it?

## The puzzle

Nationalism is arguably the most powerful political force of the last two centuries. Why do the dominant IR traditions handle it so awkwardly?

## Four Lenses on Nationalism

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| Lens           | What it sees                                                                                                                                                   |
|----------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Realist        | Nationalism is fuel for state power: it lets leaders mobilize populations for war, taxation, and territorial claims. Useful, sometimes dangerous.              |
| Liberal        | Nationalism in its civic form supports self-determination, popular sovereignty, and democratic citizenship. Liberal nationalism is the Wilsonian inheritance.  |
| Constructivist | Nationalism is a set of socially shared ideas about who “we” are. Identity is not a fixed input; it is constructed and contested through politics.             |
| Marxist        | Nationalism is ideology – a way of papering over class conflict by binding workers and capitalists into a shared imagined community. Anderson sat partly here. |

Sources: Heywood & Whitham (2023), ch. 8; Griffiths and Sullivan (1997).



# Two Faces of Nationalism

## The civic–ethnic axis

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- **Civic nationalism** grounds membership in shared political institutions, laws, and commitments. In principle, anyone who accepts the institutions can join. (France's revolutionary tradition; the United States in self-image.)
- **Ethnic nationalism** grounds membership in descent, language, religion, or shared history. Membership is harder to acquire and harder to lose. (19th-century German romanticism; many post-colonial cases.)
- These are ideal types, not mutually exclusive. All nationalisms mix the two to a greater or lesser extent, and the mix shifts over time. The empirical question is always which axis is doing the heavier work in a given case, right now.

## Wilsonian and Reactionary Nationalism

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- **Wilsonian (or classical liberal) nationalism** ties the nation to self-determination and popular sovereignty. Its motto: every nation should govern itself, free of imperial rule.
- **Reactionary nationalism** runs the other way: it ties the nation to a recovered glorious past, defines membership narrowly, and frames foreigners and minorities as threats.
- The same political vocabulary – nation, sovereignty, the people – can serve either project. The analytical question is which one a given movement is actually doing.

# Korea and Ukraine: Solidarity in Crisis

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## Two Cases on the “Bad Ethnic, Good Civic” Story

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Ethnic nationalism is usually treated as the dangerous face of the doctrine – and in some cases, it has been: Nazi Germany, Hindutva exclusion, white nationalism in the United States.

- But ethnic nationalism has also done *self-preservation* work for groups whose statehood was destroyed or threatened.
- And the “civic” alternative is not always available, even under existential threat.

Two short cases on either side of that tension: Korea under Japanese rule, and Ukraine since 2014.

# South Korea: Ethnic Nationalism Without a State

1910–1945, and its long shadow

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- Under Japanese colonial rule (1910–1945), the Korean state was abolished. There were no Korean institutions to anchor a civic identity around.
- What survived was an ethnic-cultural narrative: shared blood (*tanil minjok*), the Korean language, the script, a remembered dynastic past. This became the spine of anti-colonial resistance.
- Shin (2006) reads modern South Korean nationalism as fundamentally ethnic in origin – a response to the absence of statehood, not its expression.

And today?

The ethnic framing collides with rising migrant stock, international marriages, and a new generation of multicultural children.

## South Korea in ISSP 2023

### Ethnic items well above NL and the US

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| % rating each item "important" for being truly part of one's country | NL  | KR         | US  |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------|-----|------------|-----|
| Have been born in your country                                       | 58% | <b>88%</b> | 50% |
| Have ancestry from your country                                      | 36% | <b>76%</b> | 33% |
| Be of the dominant religion                                          | 13% | <b>54%</b> | 35% |
| Have your country's citizenship                                      | 84% | 92%        | 90% |
| Respect institutions and laws                                        | 91% | 89%        | 89% |

Ethnic items sit much higher in South Korea than in the Netherlands or the US. Civic items at the bottom are high everywhere. Source: ISSP 2023, weighted. "Important" = "very" or "fairly".

# Ukraine: A Counter to a Counterintuitive Story

Civic, not ethnic, since 2014 and especially since 2022

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- Panel surveys before, during, and after the 2022 full-scale invasion show *civic* attachment rising – not ethno-linguistic exclusion.
- This includes Russian-speaking Ukrainians and respondents at the front. Identification with Ukraine as a political community has held across linguistic and regional lines (Kulyk, 2023; Onuch, 2023).
- The Kremlin's appeals to ethnic-Russian solidarity inside Ukraine have largely failed: where civic institutions exist and function, they can do the cohering work that ethnic narratives do elsewhere.

Sources: Kulyk, “National Identity in Time of War” (2023); Onuch, “European Ukrainians and their fight against Russian invasion” (2023). The popular “rising ethnic nationalism in Ukraine” framing is not what the survey evidence shows.

## Why the Two Cases Diverge

|                                      | Korea, 1910–1945                             | Ukraine, 2014–present                                       |
|--------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|
| Sovereign state available?           | No – abolished by Japan                      | Yes – contested, but functioning                            |
| Available civic infrastructure?      | None of one's own                            | Constitution, elections, institutions                       |
| Inclusion of linguistic minorities?  | Not at issue – Korea was largely monolingual | Russian speakers fully included as Ukrainians               |
| Primary axis of solidarity in crisis | Ethnic-cultural (blood, language, descent)   | Civic-territorial (the state, the institutions, the polity) |

### Lesson

Whether self-preservation runs through ethnic or civic channels depends on the institutional context, not on something fixed in “the people.” When civic infrastructure exists, civic nationalism does the work; when it does not, ethnic narratives often fill the gap.



# Break

See you in 10 minutes – we will look at the survey results when we come back.

# Survey Results

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# Class Results vs. ISSP 2023

Live HTML report on screen

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Three questions to hold while we read the charts together:

- Where does *this* class sit on the ethnic vs. civic axis, relative to NL, KR, US, and India?
- Does political ideology predict national attachment in the same direction across countries?
- In the open-ended responses, do the words cluster around attachment, or around exclusion?

# Race, Identity, and Difference

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# Identity Is Two-Way

Heywood & Whitham, ch. 9

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- Identity is also “identification *by*” others – racialization, ethnic labeling, religious categorization – not only self-perception.
- This is why race in particular cannot be reduced to individual choice. People are racialized whether they like it or not.
- Identity is also a relation of *power*: which identity gets to count as the default, and which gets marked as different?

Source: Heywood & Whitham (2023), ch. 9, p. 257.

# Othering

## The political work of difference

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- Nations are defined as much by who is *outside* as by who is inside. The boundary work is constitutive.
- Anti-immigrant politics, civilizational rhetoric, and “us versus them” framings all do the same kind of othering. They convert difference into hierarchy.
- This is why nationalism and racism so often appear together: the boundary mechanism is structurally similar, even when nationalism is not intrinsically racist.



The Berlin Wall (1961–1989) – the literal architecture of othering. *Source: Wikimedia Commons.*

# Hindutva: A Live Case

India, 2014–present

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- The BJP's project under Modi has redefined Indian national identity along religious lines – Hindu by religion, Indian by political identity.
- Muslims, Christians, and other minorities sit awkwardly inside this redefinition. Citizenship-amendment laws, lynching campaigns, and rhetorical exclusion all push in the same direction.
- Nationalism is not finished, and the ethnic–civic line can shift quickly inside a single state.



Narendra Modi, official portrait.

*Source: PIB / Wikimedia Commons.*

# Gender and Nationalism

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# The Masculinist Nation

Nagel (1998), *Ethnic and Racial Studies*

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*"Nationalism is a project of nation-building, but also a project of gender-building."* – after Nagel (1998), p. 113.

- The “classics” of nation- and state-building – Lipset, Marshall, Deutsch, Moore – are stories about men. The literature is structured around *political man*.
- Nagel's argument: this is by design, not oversight. The nation itself is an *ideologically masculine* project, organized around honor, sacrifice, defense, and conquest.
- Bringing women back in is necessary but not sufficient. The harder question is what the masculinist framing has been doing all along.



*Liberty Leading the People*, Delacroix (1830).

Marianne leads a column of armed men.

Source: *Wikimedia Commons*, public domain.

# Mothers of the Nation

## Gendered places in national politics

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- In nationalist iconography, men do war and rule; women carry, raise, and embody the nation.
- “Patriotic motherhood” assigns women a specific reproductive duty – biological and cultural. Their bodies become national property.
- Fertility, marriage, and immigration laws so often appear in nationalist programs because reproductive autonomy is itself a nationalist question: who reproduces the nation, and on what terms.



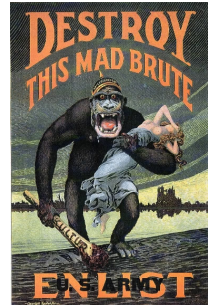
*Bharat Mata*, Tagore (1905). Source: Wikimedia Commons, public domain.

# Sexualized Militarism

## The work of the gendered enemy

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- Nationalist mobilization for war routinely sexualizes the adversary: enemy men are framed as both predatory and emasculated; enemy women as licentious and dishonorable.
- The same operation defends the masculine and heterosexual character of military and political institutions. Gender nonconformity becomes coded as national betrayal.
- Three puzzles Nagel says this helps explain: why men defend masculine institutional preserves so fiercely, why men go to war, and why men and women hold systematically different priorities for “the nation.”



*Destroy this Mad Brute, Hopps (1918), US Army poster. Source: US Library of Congress, public domain.*

# Nationalism, Gender, and Immigration Politics

## Where the threads tie together

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- Contemporary nationalist politics frames immigrants – especially men – as threats to “our” women. The 2015–16 European refugee debate ran on this template; Trumpism on the U.S. southern border runs on it now.
- The same frame puts women in dual positions: as victims who need national protection, and as reproducers whose own choices must be policed in the national interest.
- Gender is one of the main rails on which nationalism runs – a structural feature, not a side issue.

# Nationalism Today

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## Resurgence

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- Brexit (2016), the first Trump term, the AfD's rise in Germany, Le Pen's strength in France, Orbán in Hungary, Meloni in Italy, Modi's Hindutva in India, the second Trump administration: a wave of explicitly nationalist politics across very different polities.
- The shared features: anti-globalist economic rhetoric, exclusionary identity claims, a recovered-glory historical narrative, and hostility to international institutions.
- The differences are real too: religious nationalism (India), economic nationalism (Trump), civilizational nationalism (Orbán, Putin), revanchist nationalism (Russia).

# Globalization and Its Backlash

Where this leaves us, and where next week picks up

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- The first wave of post-Cold War IR theorizing assumed globalization would erode the nation-state – transnational flows, multilateral institutions, cosmopolitan publics.
- That prediction was half right and half wrong. Flows did intensify; the institutional infrastructure did expand. But the nation reasserted itself, often *because* of those changes.
- Nationalism in 2026 is a 21st-century response to the conditions the post-1989 order created – not a 19th-century holdover.

## Next week

Rodrik on the trilemma of globalization – how the nation-state, hyperglobalization, and democracy fit together (or do not).

# **Appendix: Definitions of Nationalism**

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## Appendix: Definitions of Nationalism

### Six commonly cited scholars

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| Scholar                    | Definition                                                                                                                                                                          | Ethnicity?    |
|----------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|
| Anderson (1983, pp. 6, 36) | "A new way of linking fraternity, power, and time meaningfully together" by constructing "an imagined political community – and imagined as both inherently limited and sovereign." | Not necessary |
| Connor (1994, p. xi)       | "Nation connotes a group of people who believe they are ancestrally related. Nationalism connotes identification with and loyalty to one's nation as just defined."                 | Essential     |
| Gellner (1983, p. 1)       | "Primarily a political principle, which holds that the political and the national unit should be congruent."                                                                        | Not necessary |

## Appendix: Definitions of Nationalism (cont.)

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| Scholar                      | Definition                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Ethnicity?                 |
|------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------|
| Greenfeld (1992, back cover) | "A movement and a state of mind that brings together national identity, consciousness, and collectivities."                                                                                                                                                           | Often linked, not required |
| Hechter (2000, pp. 7, 14)    | "Collective action designed to render the boundaries of the nation congruent with those of its governance unit... Nations constitute a subset of ethnic groups. They are territorially concentrated ethnic groups."                                                   | Essential                  |
| Smith (1999, p. 18)          | "A modern ideological movement, but also the expression of aspirations by various social groups to create, defend or maintain nations – their autonomy, unity and identity – by drawing on the cultural resources of pre-existing ethnic communities and categories." | Essential                  |

Source: Mylonas & Tudor, *Varieties of Nationalism* (Cambridge UP, 2023, p. 7), as compiled by Munck.

## Appendix: References

Cited on slides; full bibliography in the reading guide

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